NIT-C Students Use PostSQL

to Design Their Own Video File Repository

The students of NIT-C, who were one of the winners of the EnterpriseDB PostgreSQL contest, share with the *Linux For You team* how they created an internal database of MIT and IIT video lectures, using open source tools.

Where there is enthusiasm, one sees no barriers. A bunch of enthusiastic young students from the National Institute of Technology, Calicut (NIT-C), have proved this adage true. Every year, the IITs, the IISc and MIT upload to their website hundreds of useful lectures that other students can refer to. A club in NIT-C, 'Team Unwired', recently decided to participate in an inter-college car-designing competition, and the students referred to the video tutorials that were uploaded online. One of the NIT-C students, Jaseem Abid, spotted a useful video and uploaded it on the college server, and it was a hit, achieving over 300 views in two weeks. This encouraged the students to upload more video tutorials to their server, and make it easily accessible to more people. Team Unwired asked the faculty for some more space to host videos on the college network, and since everyone would benefit from this move, NIT-C gave the team the green signal.

The initiative to upload videos on the NPTEL, OCW and TED Talks websites promotes quality learning, and the curriculum in these universities complements that of NIT-C. However, many students were downloading the same videos, and they found it was too slow to do so off the Internet. Hence, Team Unwired took up project 'Paathshaala' to create an internal repository of tutorial videos for the college. This would mean saving bandwidth for the university while providing faster video access to the students.

FOSS enthusiasts Vipin Nair, along with Jaseem Abid, a fellow developer student, were assisted by Paul Alex, who dealt with the design and managed content (and the content team) of the site. The content team consisted of 20 students, who helped make the internal video repository a reality. NIT-C provided the students with a server, some systems to test on, and a room to work from, while the group was constantly guided by the faculty.

The college provided the group with an HP ProLiant server with 16 GB of RAM, AMD architecture, eight 64-bit processors, and a 1.2 TB hard disk, running Ubuntu LTS OS exclusively for this project. "This move motivated us further, and we knew we had to make this